Incident Response: Post-Incident Report

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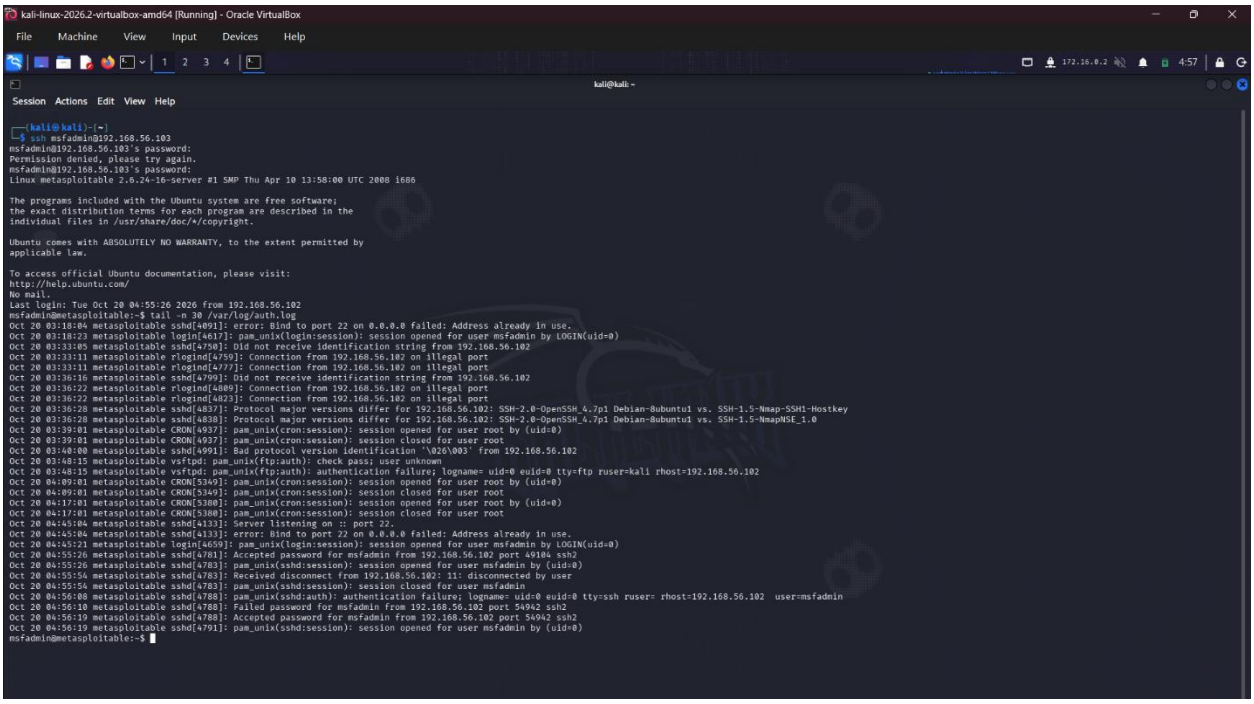
Status: Resolved / Closed

1. Executive Summary

This report documents a simulated security incident conducted during the ApexPlanet Cybersecurity Internship (Task 5: Incident Response Simulation). The exercise involved detecting unauthorized access and malicious activity within the lab environment, analyzing system logs, containing and eradicating the threat, and preparing the environment for recovery. This report details the timeline of the attack, the forensic findings, containment actions taken, and recommended preventative measures.

2. Incident Overview & Timeline

Timestamp / Phase	Description
Detection	Anomalous behavior and unauthorized access attempts were identified via system and service log analysis.
Analysis	Identified the entry vector, compromised user accounts, and extent of lateral movement.
Containment	Isolated the affected target machine and terminated malicious processes/sessions.
Eradication	Removed backdoors, patched vulnerabilities, and revoked compromised credentials.



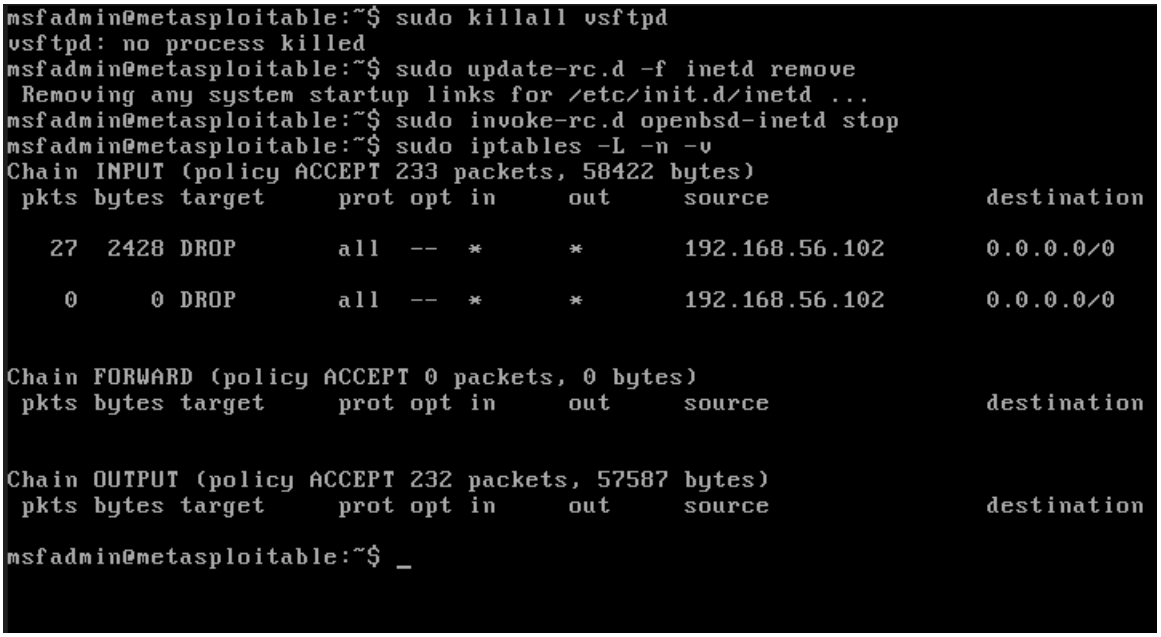
3. Incident Details & Findings

- **Attack Vector:** Exploitation of vulnerable services running on the test target machine (Metasploitable2).
- **Indicators of Compromise (IoCs):**
    - Unauthorized inbound connections on non-standard ports.
    - Unexpected privilege escalation or anomalous command execution in system logs.
- **Impact Assessment:** Limited strictly to the isolated testing lab environment (Host-Only Adapter) with zero production data exposure.

4. Containment & Eradication Actions

To stop the active threat and secure the environment, the following steps were executed:

1. **Isolation:** Disconnected the affected target machine from the lab network interface to halt lateral movement.
2. **Process Termination:** Killed active malicious sessions and unauthorized reverse shell connections.
3. **Eradication:** Cleared unauthorized persistence mechanisms, removed malicious binaries, and patched the underlying vulnerability exploited during the exercise.



5. Lessons Learned & Recommendations

- **Strengthen Access Controls:** Enforce strong authentication mechanisms and disable legacy unencrypted services (e.g., Telnet, old FTP daemons).
- **Continuous Monitoring:** Implement real-time log forwarding and analysis to catch anomalous spikes or unauthorized login attempts faster.
- **Regular Patching:** Maintain a consistent patch management schedule for all deployed applications and underlying operating systems.